

HAL 9000 AG

Expense Reimbursement Policy

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Classification	Confidential - Internal Use Only		

This Policy is issued by HAL 9000 AG and forms part of the Company's internal governance framework. It is binding on every person within its stated scope.

Article 1 - Purpose and Scope

1.1 This Expense Reimbursement Policy (the "Policy") defines how HAL 9000 AG ("HAL 9000" or the "Company") reimburses reasonable costs incurred by eligible persons while carrying out Company duties.

1.2 It applies to all employees and, where an engagement agreement or written travel authorization says so, to contractors and other approved participants.

1.3 Covered expenses may arise in Switzerland or abroad and include transport, lodging, meals, incidentals, and other costs genuinely required for an approved Business Purpose, subject to this Policy.

Article 2 - Definitions

For this Policy: **Business Purpose** means a legitimate, demonstrable objective linked to Company work; **Expense** means a personal outlay made for that purpose and not for private benefit; **Receipt** means evidence showing the supplier, date, description, amount, and currency; **Itemized Invoice** lists each charge separately; **Per Diem** is a fixed allowance authorized under Article 6; **Expense Report** is a claim submitted through the HAL 9000 Expense Console (H9 Expenses) or another approved channel; and **Approver** means a person authorized under Article 9.

Article 3 - General Principles

3.1 **Necessary and reasonable.** Reimbursement is available only where a cost is proportionate to its Business Purpose. The Company may reduce or reject excessive, avoidable, or imprudent expenditure.

3.2 **Cost-aware choices.** Travelers should select economical options that do not materially compromise safety, operational needs, or the Business Purpose.

3.3 **No duplicate recovery.** A cost cannot be reimbursed if paid directly by the Company, recovered from a third party, or already covered by a Per Diem or allowance, unless Finance Operations approves otherwise in writing.

3.4 All claims must comply with this Policy, applicable law, and project or client requirements. The stricter requirement governs unless Article 14 authorizes an exception.

Article 4 - Transportation

4.1 Eligible transport includes public transit for business travel; economy air travel for flights under six hours (premium economy for longer flights only with approval); taxis or ride-hailing where public transit is impractical for time, safety, equipment, or medical reasons; and rental cars supported by operational need.

4.2 Fines, penalties, violation surcharges, personal upgrades, and discretionary services are not reimbursable. First-class rail within Switzerland requires written pre-approval and documented justification where second class is functionally equivalent.

4.3 Tickets, boarding passes, or equivalent evidence must accompany the claim. Taxi and ride-hailing claims must record the route or justification.

Article 5 - Lodging

5.1 Standard accommodation, mandatory lodging taxes, and required fees may be reimbursed where appropriate to the destination and Business Purpose.

5.2 Nightly caps, excluding refundable deposits, are CHF 220 in Switzerland, EUR 220 in the European Union, and USD 250 in the United States.

5.3 A stay above the relevant cap requires written justification and approval. If the explanation is insufficient, reimbursement may be restricted to the cap.

5.4 Mini-bar purchases, pay-per-view entertainment, spa services, and non-essential upgrades are excluded unless specifically approved for a Business Purpose. An Itemized Invoice is always required.

Article 6 - Meals and Incidentals (M&IE;)

6.1 Meals and incidentals use receipt-based reimbursement by default, or a Per Diem where expressly authorized.

6.2 Eligible receipt-based costs include meals during business travel, bona fide business-meeting meals, non-alcoholic drinks, and customary tips up to 10%. Alcohol is governed by Article 7. Meals for family or private guests and unjustified room-service fees are excluded.

6.3 Per-person daily caps are CHF 20 breakfast, CHF 35 lunch, CHF 60 dinner, and CHF 95 in aggregate. Excess amounts need written justification and approval.

6.4 Authorized full-day Per Diem rates are CHF 70 in Switzerland and EUR 75 in the European Union. Meal receipts are then unnecessary, but proof of travel remains mandatory.

Article 7 - Client Entertainment

7.1 Client entertainment is eligible only when it has a clear Business Purpose, is reasonable, and receives the approval required by Article 9.

7.2 The Expense Report must identify attendees and roles and briefly explain the Business Purpose. Alcohol is eligible only when expressly authorized for approved client entertainment.

7.3 Unless a Director or more senior approver authorizes otherwise, client entertainment is capped at CHF 150 per person, including drinks.

Article 8 - Other Reimbursable Expenses

8.1 Essential travel supplies bought for unforeseen operational needs and necessary business communications charges may be reimbursed, subject to Articles 3 and 10.

8.2 Unusual or materially significant costs should be approved in writing before commitment whenever practicable.

Article 9 - Approval Authority

9.1 Expense Reports below CHF 300 require line-manager approval; CHF 300 through CHF 1,500 require both line-manager and department-budget-owner approval; amounts above CHF 1,500 require a Director or higher approver.

9.2 Finance Operations reviews every claim for compliance and may request clarification or further records.

Article 10 - Documentation and Recordkeeping

10.1 A receipt-based claim must show supplier, date, item or service description, total amount, currency, and available VAT or tax information.

10.2 Where a receipt is missing or incomplete, the claimant must explain why and may need alternative proof. Reimbursement may be refused if evidence remains insufficient.

10.3 Meal receipts above CHF 60 require attendees and Business Purpose; client entertainment also needs an approval reference; taxi claims need route or justification; and lodging always requires an Itemized Invoice.

10.4 Records must remain in H9 Expenses or an approved repository under the Company retention schedule.

Article 11 - Submission Procedure and Deadlines

11.1 Claims must be filed through H9 Expenses or an alternative channel designated by Finance Operations when portal access is unavailable.

11.2 Submission is due within 30 calendar days of the expense. Claims filed after 30 but within 60 days need line-manager approval and written justification. Claims older than 60 days are normally rejected unless the Finance Director grants an Article 14 exception.

Article 12 - Reimbursement Method and Timing

12.1 Approved amounts are paid to the claimant's designated salary account or another approved payment method on record.

12.2 The target processing time is 10 business days after final approval. If corrections or added evidence are required, the period restarts when a complete submission is received.

Article 13 - Currency and Exchange Rates

13.1 Costs may be claimed in their original currency. Claimants should not convert amounts manually unless Finance Operations instructs them to do so.

13.2 H9 Expenses uses monthly average Swiss National Bank rates where available, or another reputable benchmark selected by Finance Operations.

Article 14 - Non-reimbursable Expenses and Exceptions

14.1 Personal purchases, toiletries or clothing, traffic fines, unauthorized luxury services, and costs without adequate evidence or Business Purpose are not reimbursable.

14.2 An exception requires written Finance Director (or delegate) approval identifying the expense, justification, and budget source. Conditions may be attached.

Article 15 - Governance, Interpretation, and Updates

15.1 Finance Operations interprets this Policy and may publish guidance for consistent application. Where practicable, claimants should seek advice before incurring uncertain costs.

15.2 Claims may be audited, and claimants must cooperate and provide supporting records.

15.3 The Company may revise this Policy. The version and effective date on the first page control from publication in the designated internal repository.

Article 16 - Contact

Finance Operations: finops@hal9000.example

Expense Console Support: expenses@hal9000.example